

Welcome Back!

Hello everyone! Hopefully, you've all had a great break and are settling back in well! My name is Christian and I'm super excited to be your new Brass Band manager for 2026. If you ever have any questions, feel free to email me or see me in a rehearsal!

The link below is to the full rehearsal schedule for this term. Please do have a look at it - it also has the date of the concert this term: Friday, 20th March at 7:30pm, in the Elgar Concert Hall. Please let me know as soon as possible you aren't able to make it to the concert. The link to tickets for the concert is also below, make sure you share it with family and friends so we can pack out the hall!

<https://christianjeys.com/BBSpringSchedule.pdf>
<https://www.quaytickets.com/uobboxoffice/en-GB/shows/brass%20band%20and%20saxophone%20choir/events>

01 FIRST REHEARSAL

Wednesday 21st January.

Our first rehearsal back is on Wednesday, 21st January, in the Dome Rehearsal Room from 7:30pm-9:30pm. There will be biscuits as usual... The Soak is also booked for afterwards, as usual, though under my name. If you aren't able to make the rehearsal, please get in contact with me. That goes for all rehearsals; if you can't attend, please let me know so I can mark down your absence as approved. Please email me or text me (my phone number is at the bottom of this email or can be found in the new WhatsApp Group...).

02 WHATSAPP

WhatsApp Group.

I've created a new WhatsApp Community for the band. There is an Announcements channel for me to put out messages (largely just what is contained within the weekly emails), as well as an Announcements channel for Sam and Mike, and a General chat for everyone's use. This isn't to replace the Facebook group, just to exist alongside it. Joining, of course, isn't mandatory - though I'd recommend joining even if it is just to get notifications of last-minute changes, etc., if you don't keep your university emails on your phone.

<https://chat.whatsapp.com/DxqpPHFleWmLipFx1KQsN0>

03 UNIBRASS

Important - UniBrass!

The draw has been completed for the competition, and we are playing third from last. Tickets have also been released if any of your friends or family members would like to watch - either in person or live online.

<https://www.unibrass.co.uk/plans-pricing>
<https://www.unibrass.co.uk/event-details/unibrass2026>

It is extremely important that you fill out the linked form below - we need to know how many people are able to make it to the competition to ensure we can take everyone. The date of the competition is the 14th of February. Please ensure this is filled out **before our first rehearsal back**. Those who haven't filled it out by then will have their biscuit rights in jeopardy....

<https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSciGeoz0hiMszPcSyFxbhWNqDccZdW1DvJbGon3d3LE9Pbqjg/viewform?usp=dialog>

04 INCLUSION STATEMENT

University Music welcomes students, staff, and community members from all disciplines to take part in our rehearsals, including musicians who may require reasonable adjustments.

Reasonable adjustments can be given for a variety of reasons - please remember that not all conditions warranting reasonable adjustments are visible - and University Music is committed to supporting all members.

We aim to foster a welcoming, friendly environment, and ask members to treat others with dignity, respect and kindness. Our members should feel empowered and supported to challenge exclusionary and discriminatory behaviour in supporting this aim.

If anyone has any questions regarding our support for musicians during University Music activities, please don't hesitate to contact our Equality and Diversity representative, Dwight, our Health and Wellbeing representative, Hat, or the University Music and Concerts Team.

Dwight: ddk524@student.bham.ac.uk

Hat: her423@student.bham.ac.uk

UM & Concerts: universitymusichub@contacts.bham.ac.uk

05 INSTRUMENT STORAGE & PRACTICE ROOMS

As members of this ensemble, you are eligible to apply for access to the Instrument Store in the Bramall Music Building (second floor) or the University Music Hub (Frankland). If you are a Music student, this is automatic.

If you would like access (and are not a Music student or UM Scholar) please write directly to universitymusichub@contacts.bham.ac.uk detailing your name, student ID number, and which ensemble you play in. Thereafter, if you wish to apply for access to the practice rooms, you also need to note this in your email to the University Music and Concerts Team.

See you all soon!

Christian :)

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